

In the Talmud also and in other Jewish writings various wicked spirits occur, which have not incorrectly been identified with Parsee daeva's.* Thus it is most clearly evident that on this point especially Judaism proved very susceptible to foreign notions. It is true, that at all events in theory and in the minds of really pious men monotheism remained inviolate; God's direction of all things was not limited by the operations of the wicked spirits; therefore they were always subject to him. But by the introduction of these foreign elements the religious consciousness itself was considerably altered. In no other particular was it so deeply affected by foreign influence as in this one.

This last remark would be exaggerated and incorrect, had the Jews also taken their belief in personal immortality from the Persians. But this was not the case, however much Parseeism had to do with the formation and development of that belief. Let us begin by reviewing the facts. The book of Daniel was written before the middle of the 2nd century B.C. We find in it the expectation that "many of them that sleep in the dust of the earth shall awake, some to everlasting life and some to shame, to everlasting terror."† It is certainly not probable that the writer stood alone in this expectation, nor that it arose precisely in his days. We are not surprised, therefore, to meet in a writing of somewhat older date with allusions to belief in immortality, from which we may infer that it was embraced in the 3rd century B.C., at least by some.‡ Now we can account for this fact without having recourse to Persian influence. Jahveh's supremacy was acknowledged in Israel without limitation even before the exile; his dominion extended over the dead as well. "See now"—says Jahveh in "the Song of Moses," a production of the Assyrian period,—

"See now that I, even I, am he,
And there is no god beside me.

* Comp. Kohut, l. c., pp. 48, sqq.

† Dan. xii. 2.

‡ Eccles. iii. 21, in connection with chap. vi. 6; ix. 2, 5, 6, 10; xi. 8; comp. *Hk. O.* iii, 191, and below, Chapter X.